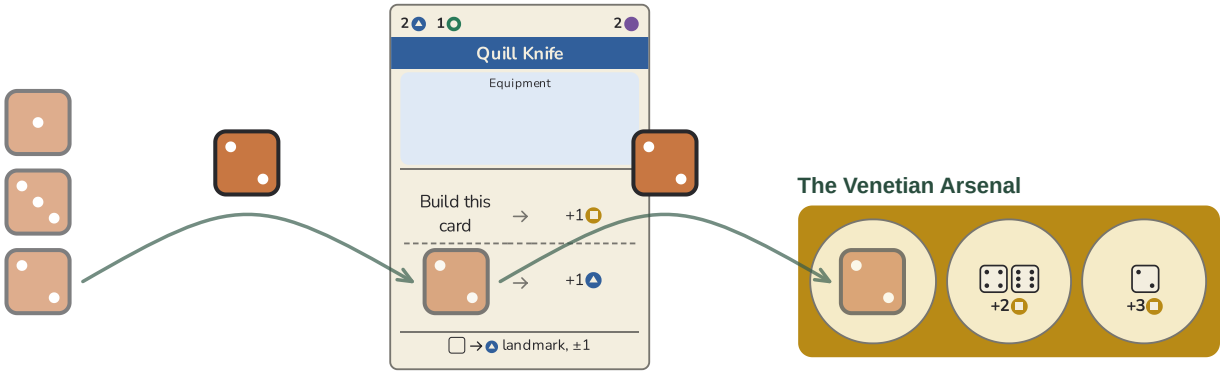
BOTTEGA

The Maestros of Venice

Players	Duration	Mechanics
1-2 Players	45 Minutes	Dice-As-Workers Tableau Building

Compete for work on the landmarks of Renaissance Venice, build equipment to improve your workshop, and craft magnificent inventions.

1. Objective

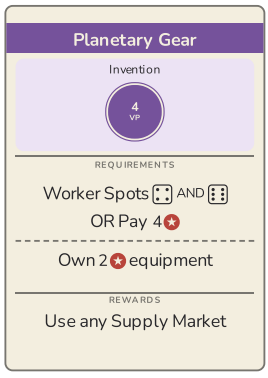


Example 1.1 A worker die's journey. From worker dice pool, to equipment, and finally to a city landmark.

Over 5 rounds, you will send worker dice to build the landmarks of Venice while upgrading your workshop and compete with other maestros for the most prestigious assignments.

Requirements and rewards grow as work on a landmark progresses, so plan carefully which worker dice you send and where.

Send worker dice to the Doge's Palace, Skt. Mark's Basilica or The Venetian Arsenal to earn Vellum, Glass or Bronze to build equipment, or let them work the Moors Tower to earn Mercury for adjusting worker dice value.



Example 1.2 Fulfilled inventions earn rewards and points.

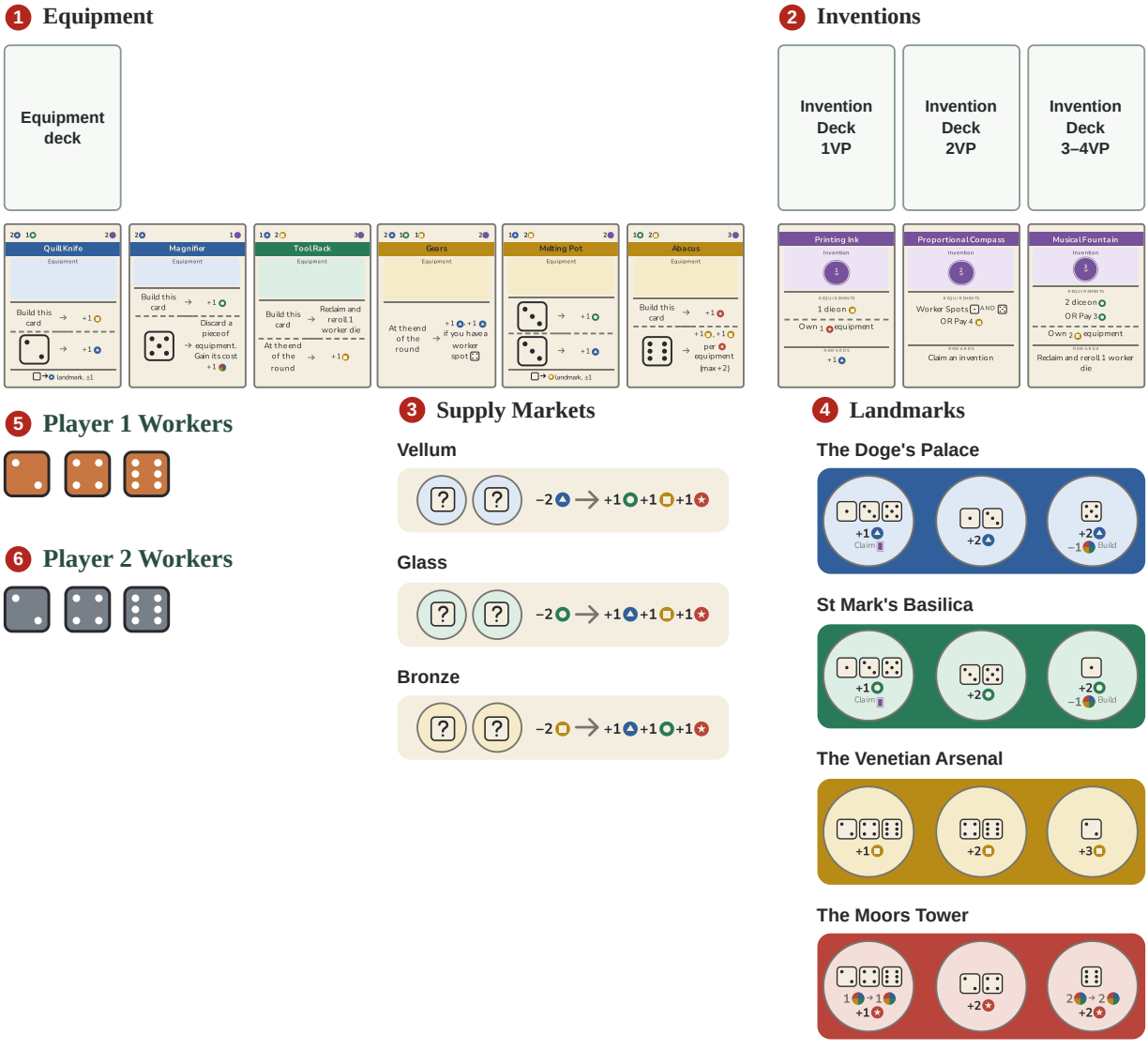
Upgrade your workshop with equipment that lets you produce more resources and helps your worker dice meet the requirements for working on the landmarks.

When a worker die is placed on the The Doge's Palace or Skt. Mark's Basilica you might claim an invention. Inventions are fulfilled for rewards and points. Bring together the right equipment and worker die placements to fulfill their requirements.

Fulfill inventions such as Planetary Gear in Example 1.2 to gain rewards and victory points, and prove yourself as the greatest Maestro in Venice.

2. Setup

1. Shuffle the equipment deck **(1)** and fill the six equipment market positions.
2. Separate and shuffle the 1 VP, 2 VP and 3-4 VP invention decks **(2)**; reveal one offer from each.
3. Place the game board with the four shared landmark tracks **(4)** and supply markets **(3)** in the middle of the table.
4. Give each player 3 worker dice and roll them **(5)** and **(6)**.
5. Place the ressource supply, consisting of Vellum, Glass, Bronze and Mercury tokens, near the game board. These should not run out, and you can substitute with other tokens if they do.
6. Each player starts with no resources, equipment or inventions. Make space for ten pieces of equipment and two unfulfilled inventions for each player.
7. Let the most accomplished maestro start the game. Give them the starting player marker and set the round indicator to round 1.



3. Components

- Six six-sided worker dice (d6), three per player.
- 44 Equipment cards and 24 invention cards.
- Game board with four landmark tracks and the 3 supply markets.
- Resource tokens: 20 Vellum, 20 Glass, 20 Bronze and 20 Mercury.
- A starting player marker and a round indicator for rounds 1-5.
- 3 four-sided dice (d4) and 1 six-sided die (d6) for solo play.

4. Key terms

Worker dice: Your three dice used as workers to perform actions.

Worker spot: A spot on an equipment card where a worker die of the printed value can be placed to resolve that spot's rewards.

Landmark spot: One of the three spots (low, medium, high) on a landmark. Each holds **one** worker die.

Landmarks: The Doge's Palace, The St Mark's Basilica, The Venetian Arsenal, The Moors Tower.

Ressources: Vellum, Glass, Bronze, Mercury

Workshop: The equipment you have built, up to ten pieces.

Supply market: Three rows where a worker die can be spent to convert resources.

Ressource Supply: An area next to the game board where ressources are stored. Whenever ressources are gained as rewards they are taken from here.

Reclaim: A reward that returns one of your placed worker dice to your pool and rerolls it.

: A ressource type of your choice. When gained/traded, you may choose which ressource to take/trade.

Note that each landmarks corresponds to a specific ressource type. This ressource type is the theme of the landmark.

5. Turn Structure

Bottega is played over 5 rounds. During each round, players take turns, performing one main action per turn. You may always pass as your main action to sit out the rest of the round.

- Before your main action, you may pay to fulfill an unfulfilled invention. Pay the printed alternatives for all its unmet requirements before receiving rewards. See Section 15: Fulfill invention.
- Take one main action
  - Place a worker die from your worker dice pool onto a landmark, supply market or equipment.
  - Place a worker die from equipment onto a landmark or supply market.
  - Build equipment
  - Pass and hand over the turn.
- Immediately after placing a worker die or building equipment, check your unfulfilled inventions to see if any are fulfilled.

Placing a worker die on a landmark or equipment requires a specific dice value. You may adjust a worker die's value by ±1 for each 1 you pay, as many times as you can afford. Values wrap between 1 and 6, so increasing a 6 results in 1 and vice versa.

6. Pass

You may pass even if you still have legal actions available. Passing uses your main action and grants no resources. Resolve your normal automatic invention check and any resulting rewards.

> **After you pass** You take no more turns this round.
>
> Your equipment still gives passive rewards, but you make no choices.
>
> Your worker dice stay where they are until the round ends.

Your opponent may continue taking turns until they also pass. Once both players have passed, the round ends. Follow Section 7: Round Structure before starting the next round or scoring.

7. Round Structure

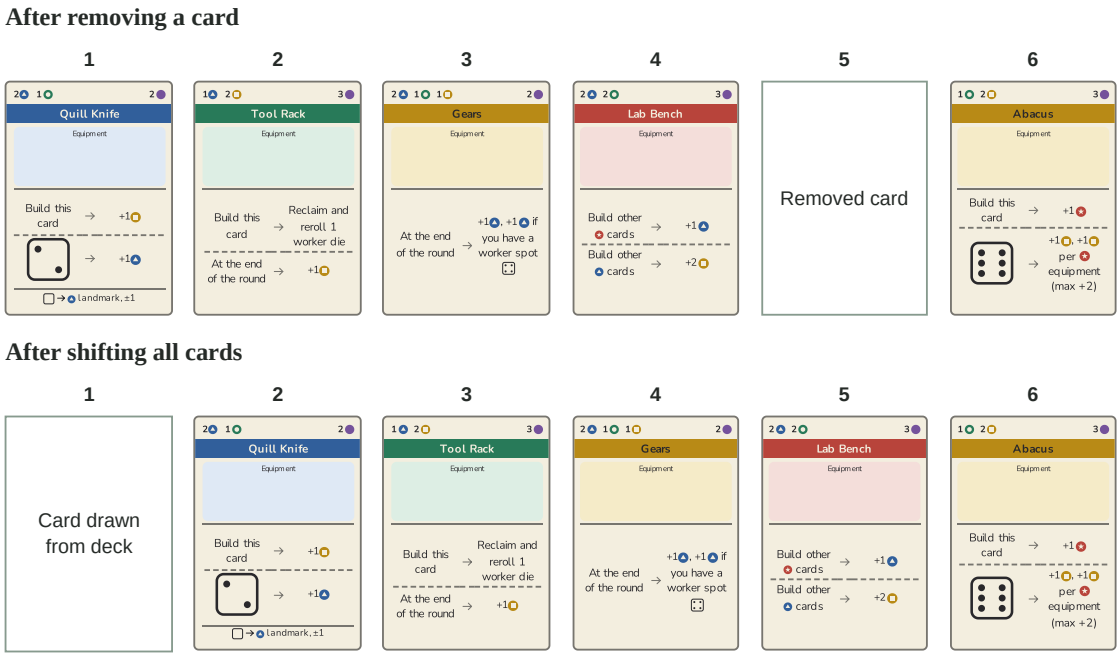
After all players have passed, resolve every equipment card's round-end rewards.

After round 5, go directly to Section 16: Scoring. Do not perform cleanup or roll worker dice for another round. After rounds 1–4, prepare the next round in this order:

1. Discard the equipment card in equipment market position 6, then follow Section 8: Refilling the equipment market.
2. Return all worker dice from equipment, landmarks and the supply market to their owners' worker dice pools.
3. Keep your equipment, personal resources, resources stored on equipment, and all unfulfilled and fulfilled inventions.
4. Pass the start player marker to the other player, regardless of who passed first.
5. Each player rolls their three worker dice. The new starting player takes the first turn.

8. Refilling the equipment market

After building or discarding equipment from the equipment market, shift all cards left of the gap one position right. Draw one card from the equipment deck into position 1. Return discarded equipment face down into an equipment discard pile. If the deck is empty, reshuffle the discard pile and place it facedown as the new equipment deck.



Example 8.1 Position 5 is removed. Cards in positions 1–4 move one place right and position 6 stays unchanged. Draw a new card into position 1.

9. Placing worker dice on landmarks

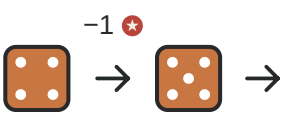
Only the **leftmost empty spot** of a landmark may be used, and the worker die's value must match one of the values printed on that spot. Each spot holds one worker die, from either player. It stays until reclaimed or the end of the round.

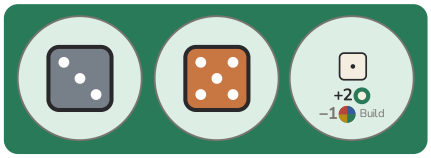
In Example 9.1, with a dice value 3 on the low spot, a 3 or 5 may go on the medium spot. The high spot stays blocked until the medium spot is occupied.



Example 9.1 The grey worker die occupies the low spot of the landmark. The medium spot is the next available spot.

In Example 9.2, a value 4 worker die is adjusted to a value 5 by paying 1 to meet the requirement of either 3 or 5 of the medium spot. Gain 2 from this placement.





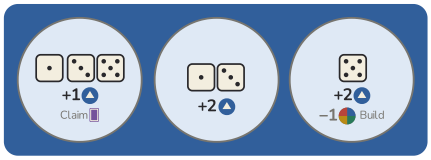
Example 9.2 Spend 1 to change a worker die from 4 to 5, then place it on the medium spot of the landmark to gain 2 .

The and landmarks have special rewards on their low and high spots. The example shows the landmark.

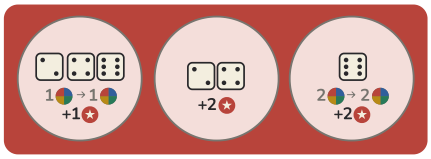
Claim : On the low spot, gain 1 of the landmark's resource, then optionally claim an invention or return an unfulfilled one. See Section 14: Claim invention.
−1 Build : On the high spot, gain 2 of the landmark's resource, then you may build equipment from the equipment market, discounted by 1 . See Section 11: Build equipment.

2 → **2** : Optionally trade one type of resource for a different type, up to the printed limit. Choose **one** type of resource to give and **one** type of resource to receive. Resources are traded from personal stock; resources on cards cannot be used.

On the high spot, for example, trade up to 2 for 2 , then gain 2 . This later Mercury cannot fund the trade.



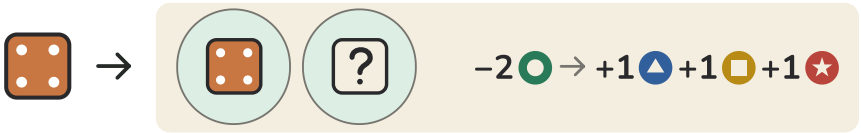
Example 9.3 The low spot of the landmark grants an invention claim. Its high spot offers a discounted build.



Example 9.4 The low spot of the landmark trades up to once, then grants 1 . Its high spot trades up to twice, then grants 2 .

10. Placing worker dice on the supply market

Place a worker die on an empty spot, any value is accepted. Pay the printed cost from personal stock and gain the printed rewards.



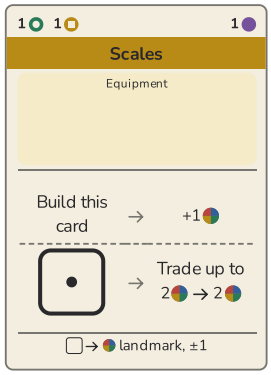
Example 10.1 Place a worker die on Sell Glass. Pay 2 to gain 1 , 1 and 1 .

11. Build equipment

You can build equipment from the equipment market as your main action. Building does not require a worker die. Your workshop can hold at most 10 equipment cards, counting each copy separately. Pay the cost from your personal stock before receiving any build reward. Resources stored on cards cannot pay costs. The resource cost of each card is printed in the top left corner.

Build Scales

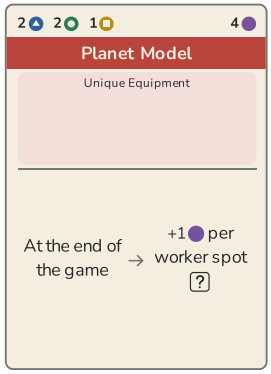
- **Pay:** Return 1 and 1 from your personal stock to the supply.
- **Place:** Move Scales from the equipment market into an empty position in your workshop tableau, face up with its worker spot empty. Refill the equipment market as described in Section 8: Refilling the equipment market.
- **Resolve:** Check if the build has fulfilled any inventions, then resolve the **Build this card** reward. Choose between , , or and gain 1 of that resource from the supply into your personal stock. Do not resolve the separate worker-spot reward.



Example 11.1 Scales costs 1 and 1 . Its build reward grants one resource of your choice.

Build Planet Model

- **Pay:** Return 2 , 2 and 1 from your personal stock to the supply.
- **Place:** Move Planet Model from the equipment market into an empty position in your workshop tableau, face up. Refill the equipment market. This card has no worker spots.
- **Resolve:** Check if the build has fulfilled any inventions. Planet Model has no **Build this card** reward, its game-end reward resolves during final scoring, not when built.



Example 11.2 Planet Model is unique. It costs 2 , 2 and 1 with no build reward.

Unique equipment: You may build duplicate copies of ordinary equipment in your workshop, but only one copy of each Unique Equipment definition per player. If a piece of equipment is unique, it is printed beneath the equipment name as seen in Example 11.2. Demolishing your unique copy allows you to build a piece of equipment of the same type, from the equipment market. These restrictions also apply to discounted builds.

12. Place worker dice on equipment

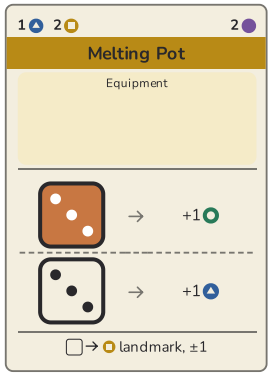
Place a worker die on a piece of equipment with an empty worker spot, and pay any required ★ to adjust its value to meet the worker spot requirement. Check your unfulfilled inventions before resolving rewards.

On Melting Pot, the first spot grants 1 ◎ and the second grants 1 ▲.

Resolve all occupied spots on that equipment in printed order, including the worker die just placed. In Example 12.1, if a worker die is placed on the second spot, both occupied spots resolve in printed order: you first gain 1 ◎ and then 1 ▲ for the second placement.

There are no restrictions on the order in which you fill the worker spots on a piece of equipment.

Worker dice placed on equipment can be moved to a landmark or the supply market during a later turn.

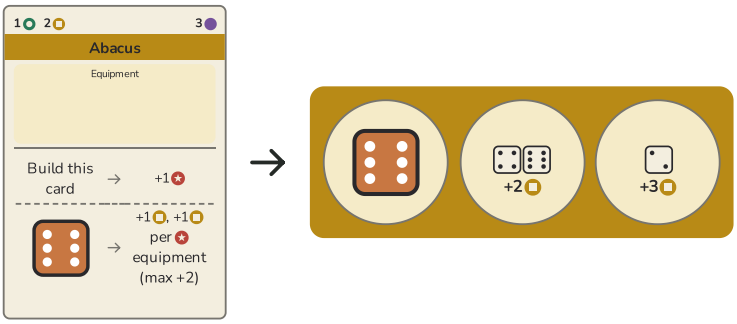


Example 12.1 Melting Pot has two worker spots. Both require a value 3 worker die. This placement gives 1 ◎.

13. Place a worker die from equipment onto a landmark

A worker die on your equipment may move to the leftmost empty spot of any landmark, if its value matches the printed values or can be adjusted to match. No piece of equipment restricts which landmark you may choose.

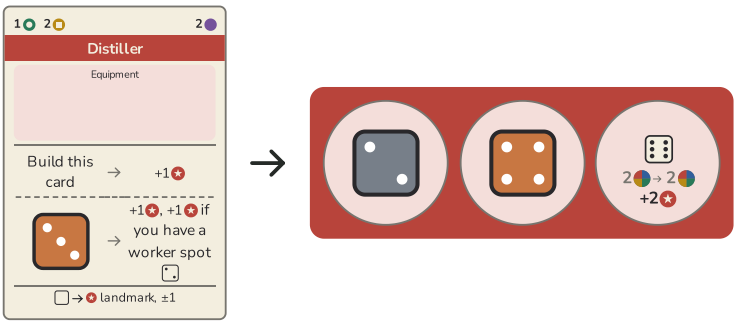
In Example 13.1, the value 6 die moves from Abacus to the low spot of the ▢ landmark without adjustment. Resolve its rewards.



Example 13.1 Move the value 6 worker die from Abacus to the low spot of the ▢ landmark. No value adjustment is needed.

An Expertise (see reference F) gives one free adjustment. In Example 13.2, the card shows ▢ → ★ landmark, ±1 which allows ±1 when moving a worker die from the equipment to the ★ landmark.

When a worker die moves from equipment to a landmark spot, resolve the rewards of that spot in printed order.



Example 13.2 Move the value 3 die from Distiller. Its **Expertise** allows one free ±1 adjustment when moving a die to the ★ landmark, so the die becomes a 4 for free and goes on the medium spot.

14. Claim invention

The reward Claim optionally lets you either acquire one invention or return one unfulfilled invention. You may hold up to two unfulfilled inventions.

Claiming an invention

- Select one of the 3 face-up inventions and privately draw one additional invention from its corresponding deck.
- Choose one invention to keep facedown beside your workshop.
- Return the other invention privately to that deck's bottom before refilling the selected offer from the top.
- If the invention deck is empty, leave the offer empty.

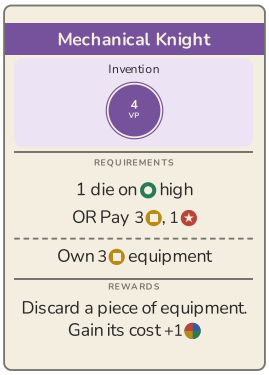
Instead of acquiring an invention, you may return one unfulfilled invention face down to the bottom of its deck. This frees a slot but uses the reward; acquiring a new invention requires a later Claim reward.

15. Fulfill invention

Immediately after you have placed a worker die or built equipment, and before resolving rewards, check your unfulfilled inventions and their requirements. Requirements count only your own worker dice and may refer to equipment in your workshop, or worker dice placed on equipment, landmarks or supply markets. If all requirements on an invention are met, the invention is fulfilled, and its rewards are immediately resolved. **Fulfilment is automatic and mandatory**, you cannot decline or save it for later. Fulfilled inventions are revealed before rewards are resolved and stored faceup next to your workshop and score their printed VP at game end.



Example 15.1 Periscope requires one of your worker dice showing 5 on a worker spot in your workshop, or payment of 3 . You must also have at least two equipment cards in your workshop.



Example 15.2 Mechanical Knight requires one of your worker dice on the high spot of the landmark, or payment of 3 and 1 . You must also have at least three equipment cards in your workshop.



Example 15.3 Planetary Gear requires value 4 and value 6 worker spots on equipment in your workshop, or payment of 4 . The spots need not be occupied. You must also have at least two equipment cards in your workshop.

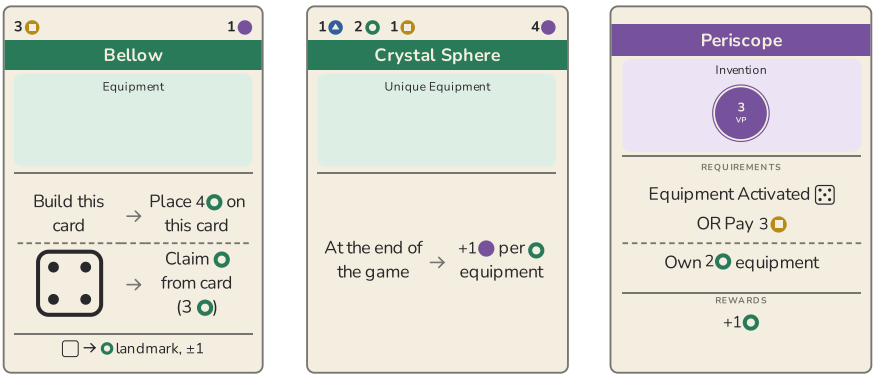
Before your main action, you may pay the printed alternatives (shown as **OR Pay**) for all unmet requirements of an invention as a free action. Requirements without alternatives must be met.

16. Scoring

The game ends after both players have passed in round 5. Finish all final turn rewards and invention checks, then resolve the round-end rewards. Do not return worker dice, refresh the equipment market or clear equipment for resources before scoring. No further inventions can be fulfilled during scoring.

Add up your victory points from the following sources, counting each only once:

- **Equipment:** Count the printed victory points (●) on every equipment card still in your workshop. Discarded equipment scores nothing.
- **Fulfilled inventions:** Count the printed victory points on all your fulfilled inventions. Unfulfilled inventions score nothing.
- **Victory point rewards:** Resolve your equipment's game-end rewards and add any other victory point rewards. Calculate bonuses from the final board state after the round-end rewards. A scoring card counts itself if it meets its own requirement.
- **Resources:** your leftover resources score as one combined pool, in two steps:
  1. Add all ▲, ○, ▢ and ★ in your personal stock to the resources stored on your equipment.
  2. Divide by 2 and round down: that is your victory points, rounded once for the whole pool, not per card. They are in addition to any card specific scoring rewards.



Example 16.1 Bellow and Crystal Sphere in your workshop, with three ○ stored on Bellow and one ★ in personal stock, plus the fulfilled invention Periscope.

In Example 16.1, Bellow scores 1 printed victory point, Crystal Sphere scores 4 and the fulfilled Periscope scores 3. Crystal Sphere also scores 1 victory point for each ○ equipment card: Bellow and Crystal Sphere itself give 2 bonus points. The three ○ stored on Bellow and one ★ in personal stock form a pool of four resources, giving 2 points. The total is **1 + 4 + 3 + 2 + 2 = 12 victory points**. All four resources remain in place.

The player with the most victory points wins. If the totals are equal, the number of victory points from inventions is used to break the tie. If the players are still tied, they share the victory.

17. Solo play - The Mad Maestro

Additional automaton components: 1 d6 (six-sided die), 3 d4 (four-sided dice)

Play five rounds with your three worker dice and the normal equipment and invention rules. The automaton has no resources, equipment, inventions or score. It competes for landmark spots and removes equipment from the equipment market.

For solo setup, use only one copy of each equipment card.

At the start of each round, roll a six-sided die and mark equipment market position 1–6. The marker stays on that position even when cards move or are built. The marked card remains available to build.

After each of your **first three worker die placements onto a landmark or the supply market**, perform the immediate invention check, finish rewards and choices, then roll a d4 for the automaton.

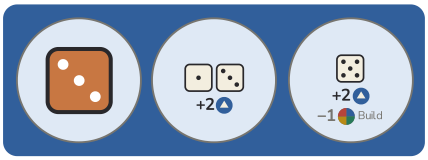
The d4 roll selects a landmark in this order: **1:** ▲, **2:** ●, **3:** ■, **4:** ★. Place the d4 in its leftmost empty spot as a blocker, ignoring allowed die values. If full, try the next landmark, wrapping from 4 to 1.

Blocker dice stay until round cleanup, give no landmark rewards, and do not count as your worker dice. Their placement triggers any equipment rewards that trigger on "Either player". After the blocker is placed, check if any of your equipment triggers on that exact placement.

When you pass, resolve round-end rewards. After rounds 1–4, discard the card currently in the marked equipment market position, clear the marker and refill as in Section 8: Refilling the equipment market. Then discard position 6 and refill again. Return your worker dice, remove all blockers, roll your worker dice and mark a new equipment market position for the next round.

After round 5, skip cleanup and use Section 16: Scoring to determine if you are a true Maestro.

The Doge's Palace



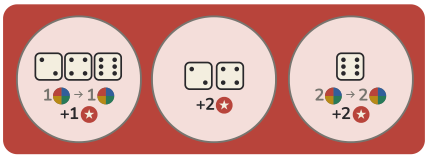
St Mark's Basilica



The Venetian Arsenal



The Moors Tower



Example 17.1 Your first placement, a 3 on the ▲ landmark, was answered by a blocker on the ■ landmark. Your second placement is a 5 on the ● landmark. Now roll the d4: a **2** selects the ● landmark, so the d4 is placed as a second blocker on its medium spot, directly after your 5.

Victory points	**<40**	**40–49**	**50–59**	**60–69**	**70+**
Rank	Beginner	Apprentice	Novice	Journeyman	Maestro

A. Resolving rewards

The middle section of an equipment card is split into triggers and rewards. Triggers define when rewards are resolved, while rewards specify the outcome. When a worker die placement or a game event matches a trigger, its rewards are immediately resolved.

B. Triggers

A card reward is either triggered by placing a dice on a piece of equipment, or by some other game event. Below is a list of the possible trigger types.

Card trigger	When its rewards resolve
 When a worker die is placed on this	Resolve every reward for each occupied spot on equipment in printed order, once per occupant.
Build this card	Resolve its rewards when this card is built.
Build other / / / cards	Resolve its rewards when you build another piece of equipment of the matching theme.
Place die on low / medium / high spot / / /	When you place a worker die on a spot with the matching level on the matching landmark, resolve this card's rewards.
Either player places die on high spot	Resolve this card's rewards when either player places a worker die on the high spot of any landmark.
At the end of the round	Resolve this card's rewards after both players pass.
At the end of the game	Resolve this card's rewards during final scoring.

C. Rewards

Reward	Resolution
+1/+2/+3 ▲/●/■/★/◔	Gain the shown resource amounts from the supply.
Trade up to **N** ◔ → ◔	Pay from personal stock. Choose one resource type to give and a different type to receive. Repeat that same trade up to N times.
Place 1 ▲/●/■/★ on this card	Take the named resource from the supply and store it on this equipment, not in personal stock.
Claim resources from card	Move all resource types stored on that card to personal stock.
Reclaim 1 worker die	Choose one placed worker die to reroll and return it to your worker dice pool.
Use any Supply Market	Pay a chosen supply market's cost before gaining its rewards, without placing a worker die. Full rows are eligible.
Discard a piece of equipment. Gain its cost +1 ◔	Optionally discard owned equipment with no worker dice on it. Gain its full printed cost plus one chosen resource. Return any resources stored on it to the supply.
+N ●	Gain N Victory points at game end.
Build equipment discounted by 1 ◔ OR −1 ◔ Build	You may build a piece of equipment from the equipment market, discounted by 1 ◔ (resource of your choice).
Claim an invention OR Claim 🂠	Acquire an available invention or return an unfulfilled one. See Section 14: Claim invention.

D. Scalers

Count the matching source, multiply by its factor, then cap at the maximum if specified. Add the bonus to the printed amount; the cap limits only the bonus.

Scaler	Resolution
+1 ● per worker spot ?	Gain 1 VP for each printed worker spot on equipment you own at game end, regardless of its required value or occupancy.
+1 ★, +1 ★ if you have a worker spot ⚄	Gain the base 1 ★. Add 1 if any printed worker spot on your equipment accepts a 2. The matching spot may be empty.
+1 ■, +1 ■ per ★ equipment (max +2)	Gain the base 1 ■ plus 1 for each ★ equipment you own. The scaler adds at most 2.

E. Requirements

Requirement	What qualifies
Worker Spots AND	Own the required printed worker spots. The spots may be empty.
Equipment Activated AND	Have a worker die showing each of the shown values placed on a worker spot of your equipment. A worker die that has moved on to a landmark or the supply market no longer counts.
1 worker die on high landmark spot	Have one of your worker dice on the high spot of the landmark.
2 worker dice on landmark	Have two of your worker dice on the landmark, on any of its spots.
1 worker die on medium landmark spot	Have one of your worker dice on the medium spot of any landmark.
1 worker die on high landmark spot	Have one of your worker dice on the high spot of any landmark.
1 worker die on supply market	Have one of your worker dice placed on the supply market (Sell Vellum).
Own 2 equipment	Own two equipment cards.
OR Pay 3	Printed below a requirement. You may meet that requirement by paying the shown resources instead. Pay before your main action and only if you can pay for all unmet requirements of the invention at once. See Section 15: Fulfill invention.

F. Expertise

An Expertise is printed at the bottom of some equipment. When you move a worker die from equipment with an Expertise to a landmark that matches it, you may adjust its value by one step (±1) for free. Further steps cost 1 each. Expertise does not apply to worker dice placed from your worker dice pool, to equipment, or to the supply market.

Expertise	Free adjustment applies when moving to
→ landmark, ±1	The landmark.
→ landmark, ±1	The landmark.
→ landmark, ±1	The landmark.
→ landmark, ±1	The landmark.
→ landmark, ±1	Every landmark.